

Meridian Robotics — Employee Handbook (FY2026)

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1. About This Handbook

This handbook summarizes the policies that apply to all full-time and part-time employees of Meridian Robotics, Inc. ("Meridian", "the Company"). Where a policy conflicts with a signed employment agreement, the signed agreement governs.

2. Working Hours & Remote Work

- Standard hours are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM in the employee's local time zone, with a one-hour unpaid lunch.
- Core collaboration hours, during which all employees must be reachable, are 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM Pacific Time.
- Employees may work remotely up to three (3) days per week. Fully remote arrangements require VP approval and an approved home-office stipend request.
- Hardware for remote work is provisioned by IT (see the IT Troubleshooting Guide).

3. Paid Time Off (PTO)

- Full-time employees accrue 1.67 PTO days per month (20 days/year).
- PTO begins accruing on the first day of employment but may not be used during the first 30 days without manager approval.
- Unused PTO carries over up to a maximum of 10 days into the next calendar year.
- PTO requests must be submitted at least five (5) business days in advance through the People Ops tool (`request_pto``). Requests of 10+ consecutive days require director approval.
- Sick leave is separate from PTO: 8 days/year, no advance notice required.

4. Expense & Reimbursement Policy

- Pre-approval is required for any single expense over USD 500.
- Reimbursable: client meals (up to USD 75/person), ground transport, economy airfare, conference fees, and home-office equipment up to USD 1,000/year.
- Non-reimbursable: alcohol, personal entertainment, traffic fines, first-class airfare.
- Receipts must be submitted within 30 days of the expense. Reimbursements are

paid in the next payroll cycle after approval.

5. Information Security Policy

- All laptops must use full-disk encryption (enabled by default on IT-provisioned devices) and auto-lock after 5 minutes of inactivity.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for email, VPN, and the code repository.
- Customer data classified as "Confidential" or above must never be copied to personal devices or non-approved cloud storage.
- Suspected security incidents must be reported within one (1) hour to the Security team via the `create\_ticket` tool with category `security\_incident`.
- Passwords must be at least 14 characters and are rotated every 180 days.

6. Code of Conduct

- Meridian is an equal-opportunity employer and prohibits harassment or discrimination of any kind.
- Conflicts of interest must be disclosed to People Ops.
- Confidential information remains confidential for two (2) years after separation.

7. Benefits Summary

- Medical, dental, and vision coverage effective on the first day of employment.
- 401(k) with a 4% Company match, vesting immediately.
- Annual learning & development budget of USD 1,500 per employee.
- 12 weeks of paid parental leave for all new parents.

8. Escalation & Contacts

- People / HR questions: People Ops (peopleops@meridian.example).
- IT / hardware / access: IT Service Desk (see IT Troubleshooting Guide).
- Security incidents: Security on-call (1-hour SLA).